SQL Quest — Teacher Guide

SQL Quest · Teacher Guide · 2026-11-05

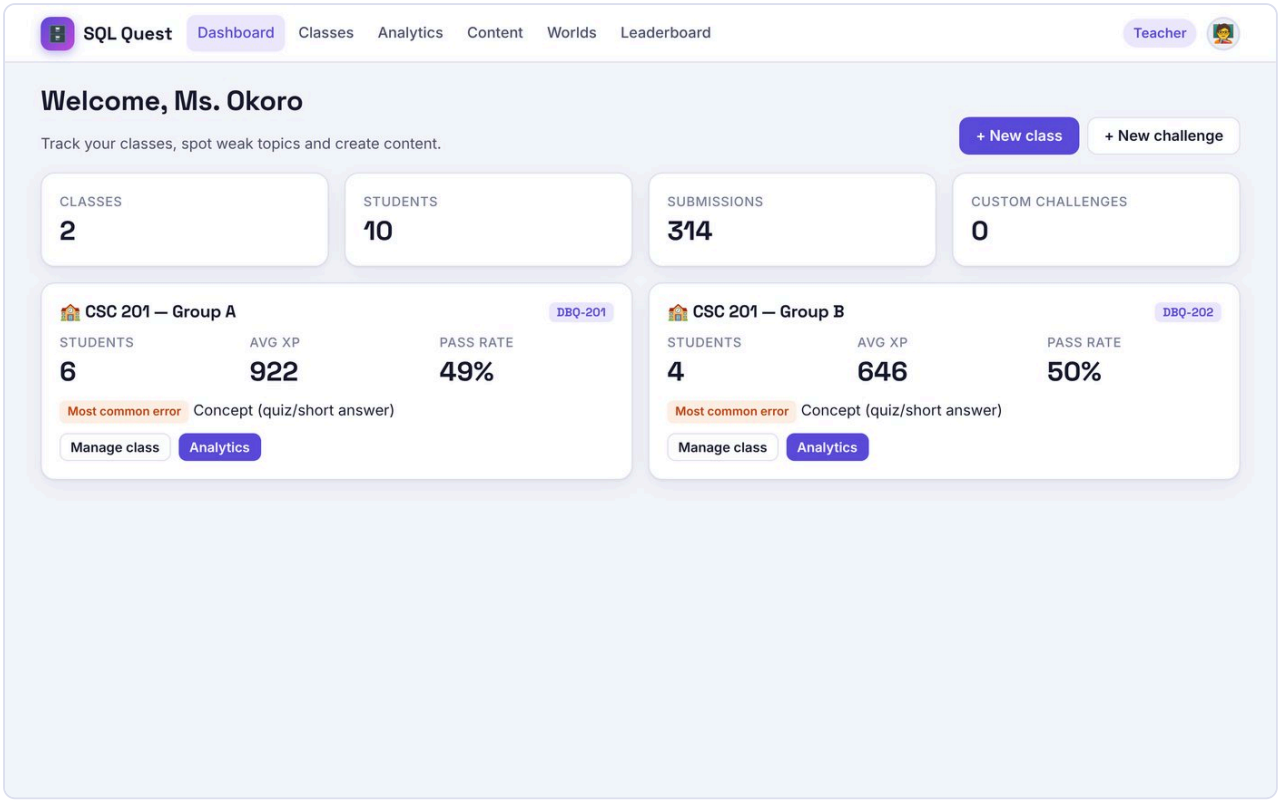
As a teacher you can create classes, give students a join code, assign worlds with due dates, form teams, follow progress with analytics, and write your own lessons and challenges.

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1. Your account

Teacher accounts are created by an **administrator** (students cannot sign up as teachers). Log in with the username and password you were given, then change your password: account menu (top right) → **Profile & settings** → **Change password**.

Your top menu: **Dashboard · Classes · Analytics · Content · Worlds · Leaderboard**.



The **Dashboard** shows each class with its join code, number of students, average XP, pass rate and most common error.

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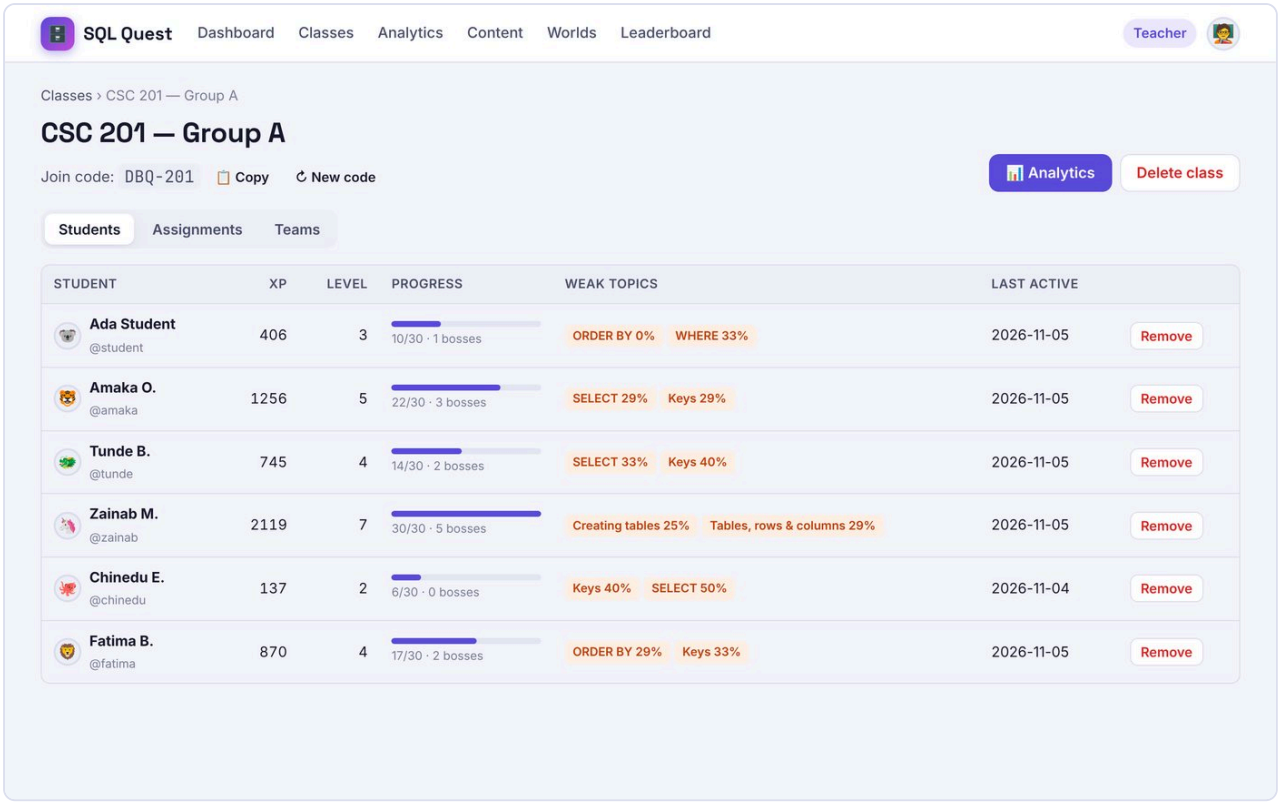
2. Classes and join codes

1. Click **+ New class**, type a name (for example *CSC 201 — Group A*) and click **Save**.
2. SQL Quest creates a **join code** such as `K7P-Q2M`.
3. Give the code to your students. They type it when they sign up, or later under **Join your class** on their home page.

On a class page:

- 📋 **Copy** copies the code.
- ↻ **New code** replaces it. Students already in the class stay; the old code stops working.
- **Delete class** removes the class with its assignments, teams and shared peer-review queries. Students keep their accounts and progress.

Students tab



For each student: XP, level, overall progress, bosses beaten, **weak topics** (topics where their pass rate is below 70%) and the date they were last active. **Remove** takes a student out of the class without deleting their account.

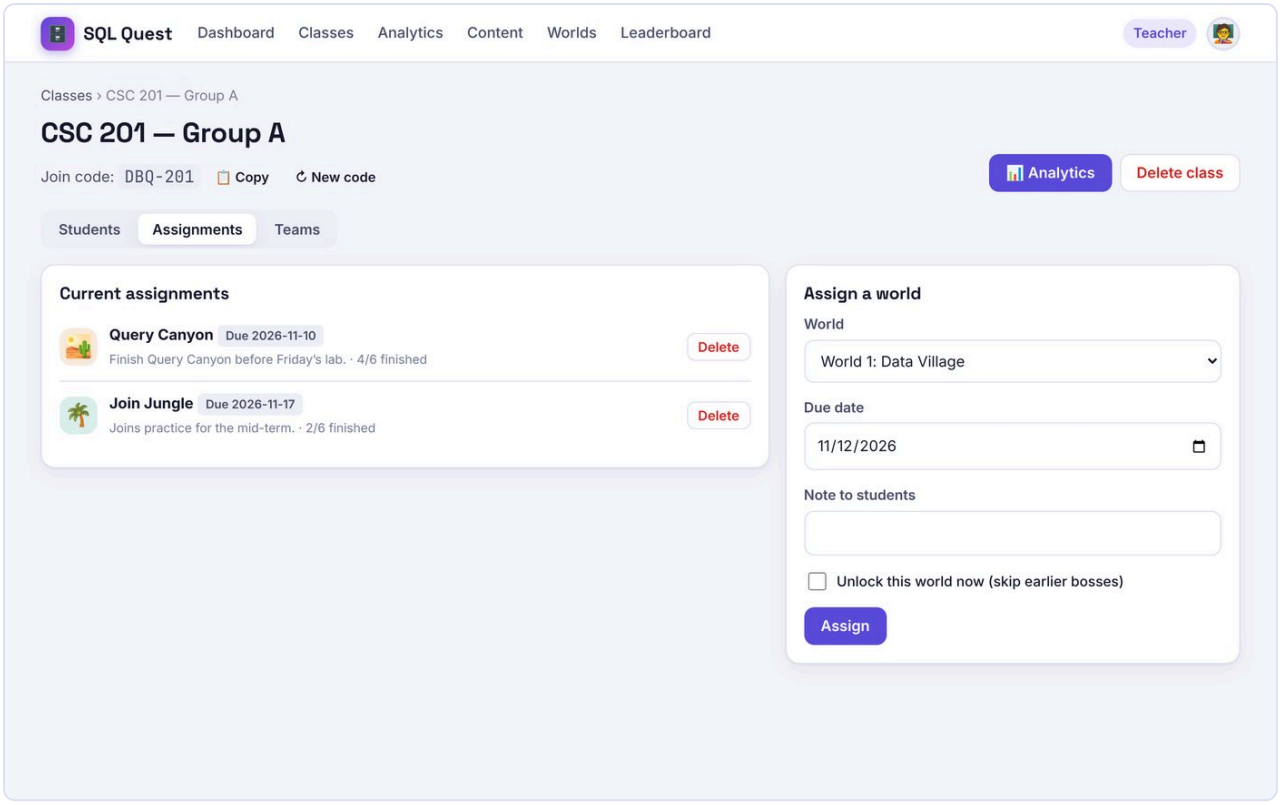
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3. Assignments

Open a class → **Assignments**.

1. Choose a **World**, a **Due date** and an optional **Note to students**.
2. Tick **Unlock this world now** if students should start it before beating the earlier bosses. This is useful for revision or for students who join late.
3. Click **Assign**.

Students see assignments on their home page, marked *Done* when they finish the world. The list here shows how many students have finished each one.

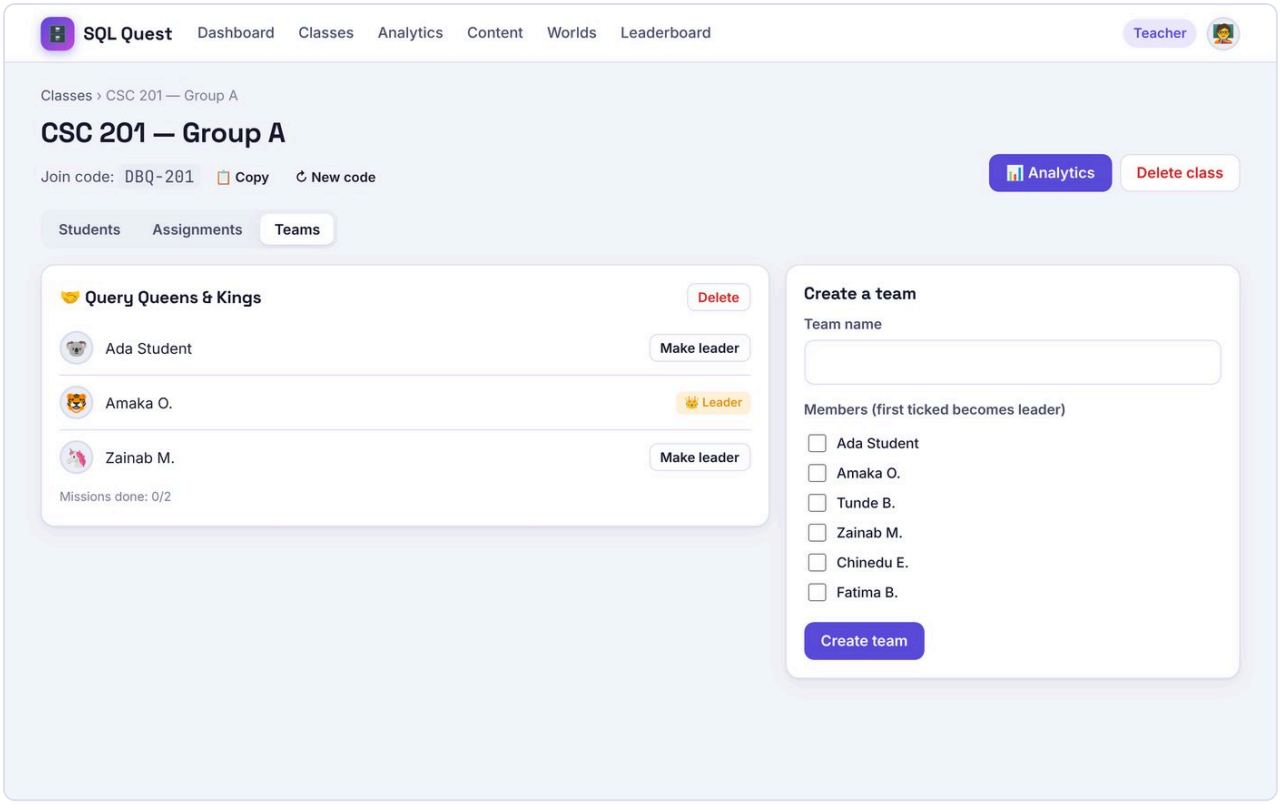


4. Teams

Open a class → **Teams**.

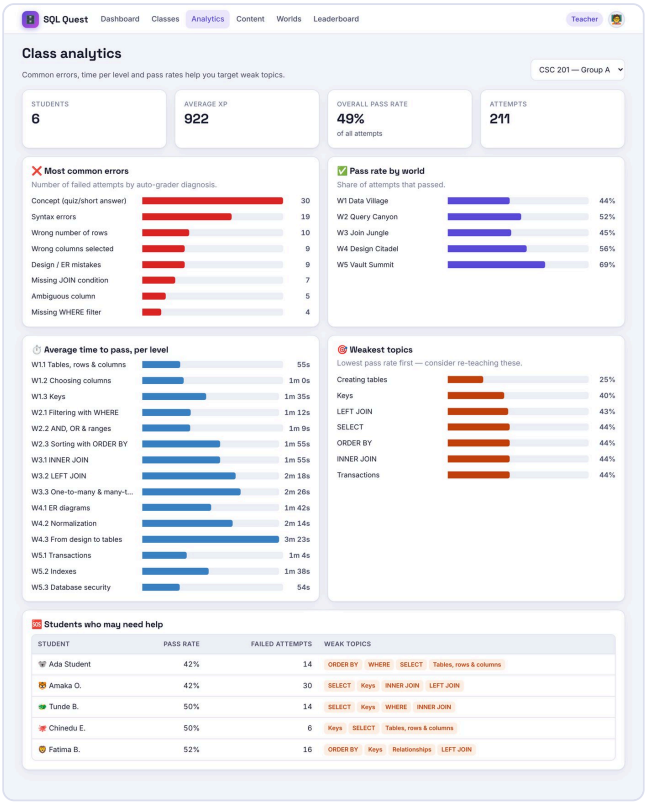
1. Type a **team name**, tick at least two students, and click **Create team**. The **first student ticked becomes the team leader**. A student can only be in one team; ticking them moves them out of any other team.
2. Click **Make leader** to change the leader.

In **Team missions**, every member can write and save drafts, but **only the leader can submit**. When the leader passes, every member earns the XP.



5. Analytics

Click **Analytics** and pick a class at the top right.



Panel	What it tells you	What to do
Students / Average XP / Overall pass rate / Attempts	Class activity at a glance.	A low pass rate with many attempts means the class is struggling.
❌ **Most common errors**	Failed attempts grouped by what the auto-grader found: *Missing JOIN condition*, *Missing WHERE filter*, *Syntax errors*, *Unknown table/column (often missing quotes)*, …	Re-teach the top one or two at the start of the next lesson.
✅ **Pass rate by world**	Share of attempts that passed in each world.	A sudden drop shows where the class hit a wall.
⏱️ **Average time to pass, per level**	How long students take to pass each level.	Long times point to topics that need more examples.
🎯 **Weakest topics**	Topics with the lowest pass rate.	Make a bonus challenge on that topic (see section 6).
🆘 **Students who may need help**	The five students with the lowest pass rates, with their weak topics.	Check in with them individually.

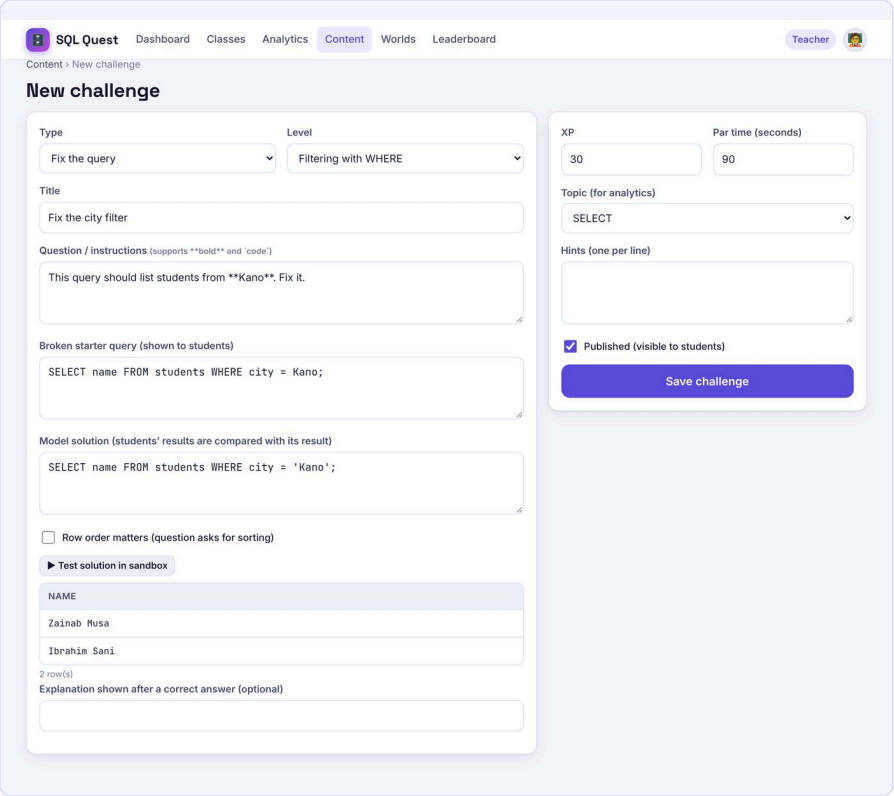
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6. Your own content

Click **Content**. Everything you create appears inside the level you choose, for all students.

New challenge

Click **+ New challenge**.

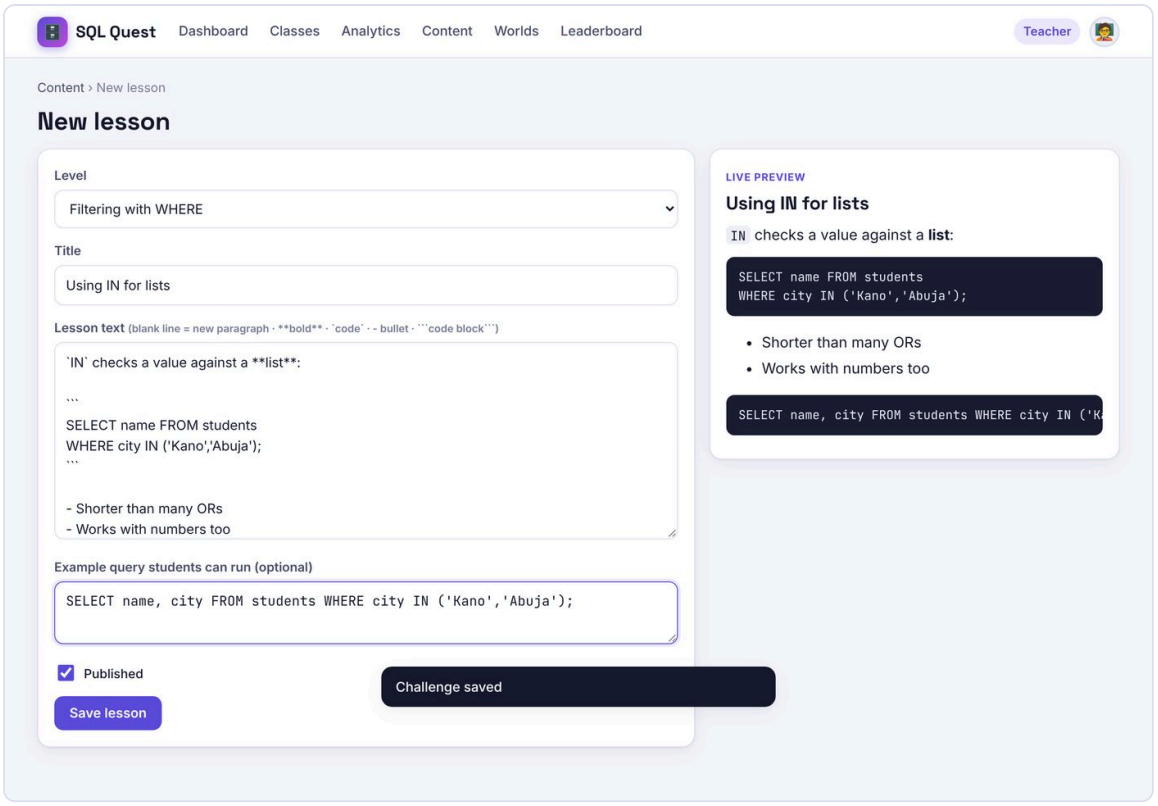


Field	Notes
Type	*Write a query*, *Fix the query*, *Multiple choice* or *Short answer*.
Level	Where it appears.
Title / Question	The question can use `**bold**` and `` `code` ``.
Broken starter query	Fix-the-query only: what students start with.
Model solution	Query challenges only. Write a correct `SELECT`; the grader runs it to get the expected result. Students' results are compared with it, so you never type the answer table yourself. Click ▶ **Test solution in sandbox** to check it.
Row order matters	Tick only if the question asks for sorting. Otherwise any row order is accepted.
Options	Multiple choice: fill 2–4 options and select the correct one.
Accepted answers	Short answer: comma-separated, not case sensitive (for example `row, record, tuple`).
XP / Par time	Points, and the time limit for the ⚡ speed bonus.
Topic	Used by analytics.
Hints	One per line. Students pay XP to see them.
Published	Untick to keep it as a draft.

Your challenges show as ⭐ **Bonus** for students. They earn XP but are **optional**, so adding one never locks students out of levels they have already reached.

New lesson

Click **+ New lesson**, choose the level, write the text and an optional **example query** that students can run. Formatting: a blank line starts a new paragraph; `**bold**`, `` `code` ``, `- ` for bullet points, and three back-ticks (```) around a block of code. The **Live preview** shows the result as you type.



Editing

The **Content** page lists your challenges and lessons with **Preview**, **Edit** and **Delete**. You can only edit content you created (administrators can edit anything).

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7. Previewing the game

Click **Worlds** to see everything students see. **Staff accounts have every world unlocked** so you can try any challenge or boss. Boss battles and practice don't put you on the leaderboard (only students are ranked).

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8. A suggested way to run it

When	Activity
Week 1	Create the class, share the join code, students sign up and play **World 1** in the lab.
Each week	Assign the next world with a due date. Open a lesson with the **Most common errors** panel from Analytics.
Mid-term	Assign **Join Jungle** with *Unlock* ticked for revision. Make a ⭐ bonus challenge on the weakest topic.
Ongoing	Use **Teams** for group work and encourage **Peer review**: reviewers earn XP and both sides learn.

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9. Questions

A student forgot their password. Ask an administrator to reset it (Admin → Users → **Reset password**).

A student can't open a world. They must beat the previous boss. To skip that, assign the world with **Unlock this world now** ticked.

Can students cheat by looking at the page code? On the **server** version, answers never reach the browser and every answer is marked on the server. On the browser-only version a determined student could find answers, so use the server version for anything that counts towards grades.

Where is my data stored? On the server version, in the school's PostgreSQL database. On the browser-only version, only in the browser you are using.